

SAMPLE COMEDY SCENE

Written by

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FADE IN:

INT. FINN'S APARTMENT - EVENING

FINN, who just turned thirty, is tall, relatively clean cut, and is standing in his kitchenette, filling two wine glasses conspicuously high with red wine.

He then heads towards his couch with a glass in each hand.

A slender early-twenties woman, EMILY, sits on the couch looking out the window.

EMILY

I can't believe you're turning the
big THREE-OH, Finn!

(beat)

I don't think I know anybody that
old!

Finn trips a little as he walks, the wine sloshes in each glass and drips on the floor as he carries them.

FINN

Don't remind me...

(beat)

Uh, here's your wine, Emily.

Emily turns to him as he hands her a glass, her eyes light up as she grabs it.

EMILY

Ooh, thanks!

(beat)

So now that you're thirty, are you
going to get married and start
pooping out kids, you old fart?

Finn grimaces as he takes a long sip of wine, allowing his silence to erase her leading question from the conversation.

FINN

So... Where's my birthday present?

(beat)

I didn't see you come in with any
big boxes. Oh wait, is it a
motorcycle?!

Emily stands and reaches for Finn's hand.

EMILY

Right this way, sir.

She leads him as she flirtatiously saunters towards the bedroom. He clumsily follows behind.

CUT TO:

INT. FINN'S APARTMENT - BEDROOM - CONT'D

Emily points to Finn's bed, he sits. She bends at the waist and pats him on his head, then walks with a pronounced hip swing over to his bathroom, turns and does a down-and-up stripper squat against the door frame.

EMILY

Just one moment, baby.

She disappears into the bathroom.

Finn puts his wine glass on his night stand, pulls off his shirt, and throws it to the side.

He sits and looks around the room, shirtless and awkward. He checks his breath and grimaces. He grabs his glass of wine and takes a sip and swishes in his mouth.

EMILY (O.S.) (CONT'D)

Finn?

Suddenly, Emily emerges from the bathroom wearing nothing but one of his oxford shirts, completely unbuttoned.

EMILY (CONT'D)

Are you ready for your present!

She wryly holds her finger up in front of her face.

EMILY (CONT'D)

(beat)

Just this once, OK?

Finn nods wide-eyed as she approaches him. He sits as she stands and presses her exposed midsection against him.

He embraces her and kisses her stomach when suddenly, his phone starts to RING.

Finn's arms instantly drop to his side as he looks to the ceiling, seemingly defeated.

Emily looks confused as Finn lets his phone ring in his pocket.

EMILY (CONT'D)

Do you need to get that?

Finn looks up at her.

FINN
(hurriedly)
Just... Hang on a minute.

Finn pulls the phone out of his pants awkwardly as Emily steps back and pulls her shirt closed like a robe.

He checks who's calling before he answers.

FINN (CONT'D)
Oh for fuck's sake...

He picks up the call and presses his phone to his ear.

FINN (CONT'D)
Ernie? What's up?

ERNIE (V.O.)
(cutting out)
Jesus, Finn! It's... I can't... We
need you... Here now!

Finn struggles to parse what Ernie might be saying.

FINN (V.O.)
What? ...What?!
(beat)
I request one day off a year, and
today is that fucking day!
(beat)
You know that, Ernie!

ERNIE (V.O.)
(cutting out)
Get your ass into work... Soon...
You can't... Now!

Ernie hangs up by slamming the receiver on the cradle. Even Emily heard the CLANG but Finn still shouts into his phone.

FINN (V.O.)
Ernie? Ernie! But it's my damn
birthday!

Finn drops the phone from his ear. Emily looks on disapprovingly.

EMILY
So... Do you have to go or
something?

Finn nods, looking like he's about to burst into tears.

FINN

Yeah...

(beat)

Can we maybe pick this up tomorrow night?

Emily shakes her head.

EMILY

That wouldn't be birthday sex then, would it?

Finn bites his lip and looks down, weighing his options.

FINN

Maybe next year then?

(beat)

Birthday sex for my thirty-first?

Emily scoffs.

EMILY

Ewww, thirty-one?

(beat)

Sorry, that's too old for me.

Finn looks down. Defeated.

FINN

Shit...

ROLL CREDITS.